2. Interruptions to Work: The interruptions to work are internal or external. Internal interruption may be caused by lack of materials with which to work, information needed is not available or because of change of work through change of plan, etc. External interruptions to work may be caused by outsiders calling the employees and external telephone calls.

3. Unequal Times needed for Different Operations: This is the major problem in the flow of work where, different operations of a job need different time to complete. For example, the sequence of operations for the first operation may require one minute, while the next may require three minutes.

4. Lack of Standard: Steady flow of work may also be affected, if the work to be done by an individual that can not equal to the standard fixed. In the absence of standard, some employees may over burden with heavy work while the others may have less work.

5. Lack of Planning and Scheduling: If the office manager does not plan and schedule the work before time, it is not possible to do the work quickly or not to do the work within the allotted time.

6. Faulty Layout: Steady flow of work may be affected if the layout of the office is not made according to a well-developed plan. Criss-crossing and back tracking procedure will affect the flow of work.

7.3. Office Manuals:

The office manual contains the details of the work to be performed in an office and other important particulars of the organization. It is the source of information, knowledge of which is essential for the performance of the work. It may be in the form of a book or booklet and contains the information which benefits the office staff. If office employees are supplied with copies of office manual they do not have to approach their superiors again and again. Therefore, they do not interrupt the work of their superiors and there is no wastage of time to office employees (new entrants) as well as to executives (Superiors).



Fig. 7.4. Office Manual

Office manual is useful to the employees, especially newly joined, can understand the work without any difficulty. The office manual contains the details of the whole office work such as standard practices, current practices, instructions and organizational policies in such a form that they are easily and readily available to the office personnel for reference and guidance.

7.3.1. Meaning of Office Manual:

An office manual means a handy form of book or booklet containing information relating to the policy, organization system, routines and procedures, methods and standards and the rules and regulations regarding employment.

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